

Zed Essentials

Curated shortcuts worth memorizing · macOS · 132 entries · synced 2026-05-19

FILES & WORKSPACE	
	Open file (fuzzy file finder)
	Command palette your universal escape hatch — fuzzy search every action
	New file
	Open file/folder
	Open recent project
	Save
	Save all
	Close tab
	Reopen closed tab
	Next tab (tab switcher)
	Previous tab
	Open settings
then	Open keymap

PANELS & SPLITS	
	Toggle left dock (project panel)
	Toggle right dock
	Toggle bottom dock (terminal)
	Focus project panel
	Focus outline panel
	New terminal (literal: ctrl-~ in keymap)
	Split editor right
then	Focus pane left
then	Focus pane right
	Swap tab left
	Swap tab right
	Toggle editor zoom (maximize pane)

CODE NAVIGATION (LSP)	
	Go to definition
	Go to implementation
	Find all references
	Go back (navigation history)
	Go forward
	Go to symbol in file (outline)
	Go to line
then	Hover (show symbol info)
	Signature help (in editor)

EDITING	
	Rename symbol
	Code actions / quick fix
	Format document
	Toggle line comment
	Move line up
	Move line down
	Duplicate line down
	Accept edit prediction (Zeta) / show next yes, Alt+Tab — overrides OS app switcher in editor
	Accept next word of prediction
	Accept next line of prediction

MULTI-CURSOR & SELECTION	
	Select next occurrence of word press repeatedly to add cursors
	Select all occurrences
	Add cursor above
	Add cursor below
	Expand selection to larger syntax node tree-sitter aware — grows by AST
	Shrink selection to smaller syntax node

FIND & SEARCH	
	Find in current buffer
	Find in project
	New search in folder (from project panel)

GIT	
	Go to next hunk
	Go to previous hunk
	Go to previous change
then	Show git blame for line (hover)
	Open recent branches

AI / AGENT	
	Toggle agent panel
	Inline assist (rewrite/explain selection)
	Add selection to agent thread
	New thread (when in agent panel)

VIM MODE

VIM · MOVEMENT (NORMAL MODE)

H then J then K then L	Left / Down / Up / Right
W	Next word start
B	Previous word start
E	Next word end
0	Beginning of line
^	First non-whitespace of line
\$	End of line
G then G	Top of file
↑ G	Bottom of file (G)
{	Previous paragraph
}	Next paragraph
%	Matching bracket
^ D	Half page down
^ U	Half page up
Z then Z	Center cursor on screen

VIM · MODES

I	Insert before cursor
A	Insert after cursor (append)
↑ I	Insert at start of line (I)
↑ A	Insert at end of line (A)
O	Open new line below
↑ O	Open new line above (O)
V	Visual (character) mode
↑ V	Visual line mode (V)
^ V	Visual block mode
↻	Back to normal mode
:	Command palette (in vim normal) Zed maps : to the command palette

VIM · EDITING

X	Delete character under cursor
D then D	Delete (cut) line
D then W	Delete to next word
C then C	Change line (delete + insert)
C then W	Change to next word
Y then Y	Yank (copy) line
P	Paste after cursor
↑ P	Paste before cursor (P)
U	Undo
^ R	Redo
.	Repeat last change
>	Indent (in visual) — operator in normal
<	Outdent
G then U then U	Lowercase line
G then ↑ U then ↑ U	Uppercase line

VIM · SEARCH & REPLACE

/	Search forward
?	Search backward
N	Next match
↑ N	Previous match (N)
*	Search word under cursor (forward)
#	Search word under cursor (backward)

VIM · LSP & CODE INTELLIGENCE

G then D	Go to definition
G then R then R	Find all references Zed's grr — references
G then R then N	Rename symbol grn — rename
G then R then A	Code actions gra — actions
G then R then I	Go to implementation gri — implementation
G then S	Symbol outline
G then A	Select all matches of word
↑ K	Hover (show symbol info)
[then C	Previous hunk
] then C	Next hunk
[then D	Previous diagnostic
] then D	Next diagnostic
^ O	Jump back (navigation)
^ I	Jump forward

VIM · WINDOWS / PANES

^ W then V	Split right (vertical split)
^ W then S	Split down (horizontal split)
^ W then H	Focus pane left
^ W then L	Focus pane right
^ W then J	Focus pane below
^ W then K	Focus pane above
^ W then O	Close other panes (only this one)
↑ Z then ↑ Z	Save & close (ZZ)
↑ Z then ↑ Q	Close without saving (ZQ)